

Akusti "AJ" Leino

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WORK EXPERIENCE

Tax Foundation

Federal Tax Policy Fellow

Washington D.C.

August 2024 - Current

- Developed and maintain interactive dashboards and reports using Tableau, Excel, and SQL to visualize key policy insights.
- Implemented statistical analysis techniques to identify trends and model policy impacts, supporting data-driven decision-making.
- Collaborated cross-functionally to improve workflow automation, enhancing efficiency and reducing manual reporting time by 40%.

George Mason University

Graduate Teaching Assistant

Fairfax, VA

August 2023 - Current

- Taught data analysis and statistical modeling courses, training students in Python, R, SQL, and machine learning techniques.
- Developed and delivered training on program evaluation, statistical modeling, and ethical data practices to 100+ students annually.
- Provided individualized technical assistance on topics including FERPA compliance, research ethics, and data storytelling.
- Created written protocols, visualizations, and learning resources to support knowledge building across diverse learner backgrounds.

Service Management Group

Research Analyst

Kansas City, Missouri

August 2022 - August 2023

- Led data analysis on consumer behavior, utilizing SQL, Tableau, and Python to extract insights from large-scale survey data from international retail brands.
- Created interactive dashboards and reports in Tableau and Excel to track key performance indicators and customer sentiment trends which I automated using ETL principles.
- Maintained documentation and trained colleagues on using R and on best practices for data integrity and privacy standards.
- Initiated research team wide transfer from using SPSS to R by teaching how to use R environment most effectively.

Linköping University

Research Assistant

Norrköping, Sweden

May 2021 - October 2021

- Delivered data analysis using R, tracking behavioral trends in university students related to university compliance issues and willingness to follow guidelines.
- Contributed to writing and brainstorming research papers on regulation compliance.
- Engaged in collaborative research with faculty and graduate students, applying computational social science methods to real-world problems.

Wilfried Martens Centre for European Studies

Policy Analyst Intern

Brussels, Belgium

February 2020 - June 2020

- Carried out policy research on European and Asian (especially China's) economic and innovation policies, producing reports and white papers for policymakers.
- Undertook drafting briefing notes, presentations, and policy summaries for think tank executives and external stakeholders.

EDUCATION

George Mason University

PhD in Data Science (GPA: 4.0) (All But Dissertation)

Fairfax, Virginia

Advanced training in machine learning, statistical inference, system dynamics, agent-based modeling and social simulations. Applied Python, R, and SQL extensively for research in innovation systems and simulation modeling. Coursework included predictive analytics, natural language processing, and complex systems analysis.

Linköping University

MSc in Data Science (GPA: 3.7) 2022

Norrköping, Sweden

Focused on supervised and unsupervised learning, statistical inference, and data visualization using tools such as Python, R, Tableau, and SPSS. Completed thesis on organizational demographics using dimensionality reduction and regression models.

National Chengchi University

BS in Economics 2019

Taipei City, Taiwan

Developed strong foundations in regression analysis, econometrics, and hypothesis testing. Applied Excel and R to analyze consumer behavior and market dynamics.